

10/22/24. SVRI Forum in Cape Town, South Africa

Double
Jeopardy
Study



Navigating Silence and Barriers: Understanding the Impact of Family Collectivism, Cultural Complexities, and Microaggressions on Asian and Pacific Islander Student Survivors' Experiences of Sexual Violence and Harassment

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Presenter: Eunhee Park, Ph.D Candidate, MPH; Department of Community Health Sciences

Agenda

- 01 Background
- 02 Methods
- 03 Results
- 04 Conclusion
- 05 Recommendations

“Model Minority Myth”

Asians living in the United States are often viewed as the “honorable White” who lack prominent social issues.



- Ignores the heterogeneity of subgroups
- Lack of research / policy focus
- Problems being overlooked



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UC
SPEAKS UP



Gendered and racialized violence and discrimination against Asian women in the U.S.

Problem *Statement*

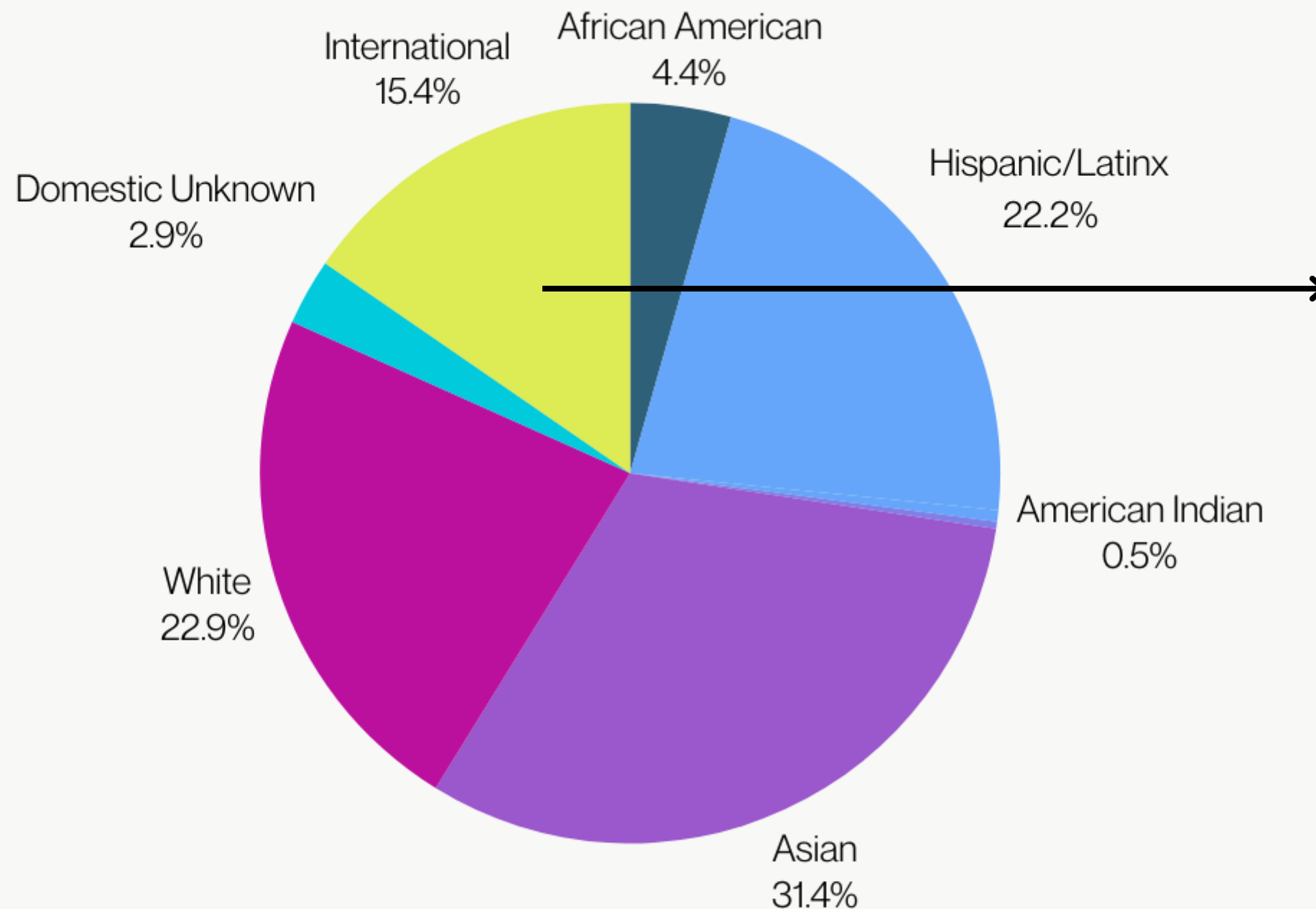


- 01 High prevalence of Sexual Violence and Sexual Assault (SVSH) on campus
- 02 Minority students are at higher risk
- 03 Cultural & familial factors and immigration background

Methods

- Mixed methods study across 10 California University of California (UC) campuses
- Convenience/ snowball sampling
- Compensation \$5 (survey)+ \$50 (interview) + \$50 (transmedia)
- Ethical approval from UCLA and reliance agreements from other campuses
- Interview guide with a focus on SVSH experiences and perception, cultural and immigration impacts, impact of COVID-19, and coping and support mechanism
- 53 interviews recorded + transcribed + analyzed

Student Enrollment *in UC*



	Studen..	Percent
China	22,837	58%
India	3,698	9%
South Korea	1,885	5%
Taiwan	1,451	4%
Canada	972	2%
Indonesia	580	1%
Japan	571	1%
Iran	421	1%
Mexico	385	1%
Turkey	358	1%

Coding strategy

1	2	3	4	5	6	7
First round of general coding	Developed coding tree	Pilot focus coding (16 interviews)	Revised coding tree	First round of focus coding	Revised focus codes	Final round of focus coding with updated codes

Main themes

1	2	3	4	5
Asian/ Family Culture	Stereotypes/ Microaggression	Healing mechanism	Barriers to services	Impact of COVID-19

Results

Perceiving Asian culture as “traditional” and “conservative”

Intergenerational differences in values and attitudes

Cross-national culture differences impacted by immigration experience

Lack of social support & negative perceptions of on-campus services

Family, especially female family members, hold stigma against DV/SVSH as “taboo”

Fetishization of API women, patriarchal norms, and intra-racial discrimination

“It came to me from a very early age, almost in my teenage years, where I was told or I was punished by my mom if I wear a certain kind of clothes, stand or sit too close to men, or even discuss questions about my body parts, which I genuinely did not know and wanted to have that kind of knowledge, but the stigma of sexuality is so heavy that the mental punishment or social pressure really push me to a corner that I feel that I might be one of the few that do not belong to the culture.”

“I think, like East Asian people are very with their feelings. We're very like, not expressive, you know, very like subtle. Like crying may not ever be seen as acceptable. So you deal with your own emotions.”

“I feel like he would prey on people who would feel bad for him. His entire circle was Asian women...like he wasn't really viewing us as like people, more like, like a stepping stone towards achieving his idea of the college experience. He had this stereotype that Asian women are submissive.”

“I do feel like sometimes, like, people assume that I will be the one that's not assertive, like if I'm in a group setting or in a big group, whether academically, socially, I think sometimes people are shocked by how assertive I can be or how much of a leadership role I'm willing to take immediately and I think people maybe don't assume that because of my gender and my ethnicity.”

Implications

Culturally Tailored Support Services

Culturally-specific mental health and SVSH services
Peer support programs

Education and Training

Introduce bystander intervention and cultural competency
Train campus counselors and staff

Improve Reporting Mechanisms

Expand survivor-centered services
More funding for confidential services
Establish anonymous reporting options

Community Engagement and Outreach

Engage with API student organizations
Collaborate with community leaders
Foster partnerships with API community organizations

Get In *Touch*

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